

thing that mattered was our direct relations with a Being infinitely high above all angelic hosts. If we are concerned with the question whether the later Judaism developed its own new world of spirits, or derived it wholly or partially from an external source, it seems enough to say that there was a system not unlike their own in the environment of the Jews of the post-exilic period ; and that, if the specialists in Old Testament theology find the later developments inexplicable by native growth, there is a possible *vera causa* in Magianism. I do not presume to decide the question, and I confess it seems to me to have singularly little importance.

One kind of "angel" who plays a small but not trifling part in Jewish angelology is very much like the Fravashi or "double," which formed the subject of Lecture VIII. Is there dependence here? The link would be easy to make, for, as we have seen, the Fravashi concept on both its sides is no part of Zaratrustra's system, but belongs partly to the ancestor-worship of primitive Aryan religion, and partly to a belief in a kind of External Soul, which may belong to Iranian or to Magian doctrine. This had its home in the countries which Jews knew well during the Exile. The conception accounts primarily for Matt. 18¹⁰ and Acts 12¹⁵. The "angel" of the little child, who has not learned to sin, stands in the very presence of God. Jesus then gives emphatic endorsement to an idea the history of which may have started far away. And the company in Mary's house are ready to assume that the "double" of the Apostle for whom they had met to pray was standing outside the door. These two passages seem to be explicable